

BASIM AHMAD

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Professional Summary

Cybersecurity graduate with hands-on exposure to **information security governance**, **network security operations**, and **vulnerability assessment & penetration testing (VAPT)**. Experienced in **ISO 27001** compliance assessment, network security risk management, audit support, and enterprise firewall and infrastructure security hardening. Certified **eJPT** holder with a strong foundation in security monitoring, malware analysis, and comprehensive security documentation aligned with **ISO 27001/2** and **NIST Cybersecurity Framework**. Proven ability to prepare governance reports, risk assessments, and **Network Security KPI** frameworks for management-level stakeholders, with strong analytical, communication, and problem-solving skills.

Education

National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences (FAST NUCES) **2021 – 2025**
BS Cyber Security *Islamabad, Pakistan*

Experience

Arwen Tech (Pvt) Ltd. **Aug 2025 – Present**
Associate Network Engineer — Enterprise Security & Networking *Islamabad, Pakistan*

- Configured and managed **FortiGate** and **Juniper SRX** firewalls, enforcing security policies, access control rules, and **privileged access governance** across multi-site enterprise client environments.
- Performed **infrastructure and server security hardening** through systematic firewall rule audits, network segmentation, and VPN access controls, reducing attack surface across enterprise deployments of 200+ branch sites.
- Deployed Fortinet SD-WAN with IPsec VPN tunnels, BGP routing, and SLA-based traffic steering, building hands-on expertise in **telecom-grade WAN infrastructure** and network security operations.
- Managed and resolved network security incidents, coordinating timely observation closure in line with enterprise **information security SLAs** and operational requirements.

Merik Solutions **Jan 2025 – Jul 2025**
NMS Monitoring, Network Support, IDS/IPS, VPNs (IPSec/SSL) *Islamabad, Pakistan*

- Network Monitoring: Managed network health using NMS tools to ensure high availability and resolve support tickets..
- Infrastructure Support: Provided technical assistance to optimize connectivity and mitigate network threats.

Protect Lab **June 2023 – Aug 2023**
Information Security & Penetration Testing Intern *Islamabad, Pakistan*

- Governed and executed **Vulnerability Assessment & Penetration Testing (VAPT)** activities across web applications and network infrastructure; classified vulnerabilities by risk level and coordinated **risk-based remediation within defined SLAs** with relevant stakeholders.
- Assessed organizational security posture against **ISO 27001** and **GDPR** standards; developed risk mitigation and risk treatment strategies, supported **internal audit processes**, and ensured timely closure of audit observations.
- Performed **network security risk assessments**, prepared draft penetration testing reports with risk ratings, and delivered **remediation recommendations and security improvement suggestions** to management.
- Supported **cybersecurity awareness sessions** and contributed to information security **governance initiatives and control improvement** activities within the organization.

Certifications

eJPT — eLearnSecurity Junior Penetration Tester *Dec 2024 | eLearnSecurity | ID: 125126585*
Demonstrated expertise in penetration testing methodology, host and network vulnerability auditing, web application security assessment, exploitation techniques, and vulnerability documentation and reporting.

Digital Forensics Essentials (DFE) *Jan 2023 | EC-Council | ID: 167699*
Practical expertise in digital forensics investigation tools and techniques for cyber incident analysis and evidence handling.

Network Security Associate 1, 2 & 3 (NSE) *Aug 2022 | Fortinet*
Solid understanding of networking fundamentals, cybersecurity principles, and Fortinet enterprise security solutions and threat landscape.

Thales Luna 7 HSM Core Engineer *Mar 2026 | Thales*
Validated technical expertise in configuring and managing Thales Luna 7 Hardware Security Modules for enterprise cryptographic key management infrastructure.

Oracle Cloud Infrastructure 2025 Certified Multicloud Architect Professional *Oct 2025 | Oracle*
Proficiency in designing and implementing complex multicloud solutions integrating OCI with other cloud providers — directly applicable to cloud-enabled telecom infrastructure governance.

Projects

Systems Security Documentation

Governance, Risk & Compliance

- Developed comprehensive **information security governance** documentation aligned with **ISO 27001/2** and **NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF)**, covering: Threat Analysis, Quantitative Risk Assessment, Enterprise Information Security Policy, Security Architecture, and Physical Security Plan.
- Produced a full **Contingency Planning** suite including Incident Response Plan (IRP), Disaster Recovery Plan (DRP), Business Impact Analysis (BIA), and Business Continuity Plan (BCP) — supporting organizational audit readiness and regulatory compliance documentation.
- Designed **Network Security KPI** reporting frameworks and control assessment templates for management-level reporting; demonstrated strong documentation, communication, and **stakeholder presentation** skills throughout.
- Developed **cybersecurity awareness** content and Security Team Hierarchy structures to support governance initiatives and control improvement programs.

Blackhole Attack Detection in RPL-based IoT Networks

Python, Machine Learning

- Built an ML-based **network security monitoring** and intrusion detection pipeline (Random Forest, Neural Network) analyzing 5.9M+ packets — aligned with **SIEM-based anomaly detection** and proactive vulnerability management principles.
- Engineered 18+ behavioral features from network traffic data to automate attack classification, supporting risk-based network threat response workflows.

MAC Address Spoofer, Network Scanner & Packet Crafting Tool

Python, Scapy

- Developed a suite of offensive security tools (port scanner, MAC spoofer, active host enumerator) to conduct VAPT activities and identify network **information security assets** and vulnerabilities.
- Built a Scapy-based packet crafting and analysis tool for network traffic manipulation and web/network vulnerability testing in authorized environments.

Skills

Information Security Governance: ISO 27001/2, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), Information Security Risk Assessment, Risk Treatment & Acceptance, Security Policy Development, Regulatory Compliance, Audit Support & Observation Closure, Network Security KPI Reporting, Control Assessment & Improvement, Cybersecurity Awareness Programs

Network Security Operations: Firewall Policy Management (FortiGate, Juniper SRX), Server & Infrastructure Security Hardening, Network Segmentation, IPsec VPN, SD-WAN, BGP, OSPF, Access Control Management, Telecom-Grade WAN Infrastructure, TCP/IP, DNS, HTTP/HTTPS

Vulnerability Assessment & Penetration Testing (VAPT): Web Application Penetration Testing, Network Penetration Testing, Risk-Based Remediation, OWASP Top 10, Vulnerability Classification, Exploitation, Enumeration, Red Teaming, Penetration Testing Reporting

Security Monitoring & Threat Detection: Network Traffic Analysis (Wireshark), Intrusion Detection (SNORT), Malware Analysis (IDA Pro, Ghidra, YARA), IoC Identification, Digital Forensics, Threat Detection, Security Event Analysis

Access Management: Privileged Access Governance, Firewall Rule Auditing & Access Reviews, VPN Access Control, Network Device Access Management, PAM Policy Enforcement

Operating Systems: Kali Linux, Ubuntu Linux, Windows — hands-on proficiency in Linux & Windows environments

Penetration Testing Tools: Kali Linux, Burp Suite, Metasploit, Nmap, SQLMap, Nikto, Hydra, Hashcat, theHarvester, Maltego, Wireshark, YARA, SNORT

Forensics Tools: Autopsy, FTK Imager, IDA Pro, Ghidra

Programming: Python, C++, JavaScript, C#, SQL

Documentation & Communication: Security Report Writing, Risk Assessment Documentation, Audit Support Materials, Management Presentations, KPI Dashboards, Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Power BI)